Liyi Zhou

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CS Lecturer (~US Assistant Professor) @ The University of Sydney

Selected Publications

Security & Reliability of AI Agents

Reliability **Can Agent Benchmarks Support Their Scores?** *arXiv'26*

S Gao, L Zhou.

Security Reliability **When Agents Overtrust Environmental Evidence** *arXiv'26*

S Sheng, Z Wang, L Zhou.

AI4Sec

AI4Sec Security **EvoHunt: Transferable Self-Evolving Playbooks for Agentic Security Auditing** *arXiv'26*

Z Wang, C W M Ng, C Yu, S Sheng, K Qin, L Zhou.

Core A AI4Sec Security **AI Agent Smart Contract Exploit Generation** *FC'26*

A Gervais, L Zhou.

AI4Sec Security **Agentic Discovery and Validation of Android App Vulnerabilities** *arXiv'25*

Ziyue Wang, L Zhou.

Blockchain

Core A* Security Privacy **Evasion Under Blockchain Sanctions** *WWW'26*

E Liu, M Ryan, L Zhou, P Berrang.

Core A* Security **Blockchain Amplification Attack** *ACM SIGMETRICS'25*

T Tsuchiya, L Zhou, K Qin, A Gervais, N Christin.

Core A* Security **Speculative Denial-of-Service Attacks in Ethereum** *USENIX Security'24*

A Yaish, K Qin, L Zhou, Aviv Zohar, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **Smart Contract and DeFi Security Tools: Do They Meet the Needs of Practitioners?** *ICSE'24*

S Chaliasos, M Charalambous, L Zhou, R Galanopoulou, A Gervais, D Mitropoulos, B Livshits.

Core A* Security Privacy **SoK: Decentralized Finance (DeFi) Attacks** *IEEE S&P'23*

L Zhou, X Xiong, J Ernstberger, S Chaliasos, Z Wang, Y Wang, K Qin, R Wattenhofer, D Song, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **The Blockchain Imitation Game** *USENIX Security'23*

K Qin, S Chaliasos, L Zhou, B Livshits, D Song, A Gervais.

Core A* Privacy **On How Zero-Knowledge Proof Blockchain Mixers Improve, and Worsen User Privacy** *WWW'23*

Z Wang, S Chaliasos, K Qin, L Zhou, L Gao, P Berrang, B Livshits, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **Quantifying Blockchain Extractable Value: How dark is the forest?** *IEEE S&P'22*

K Qin, L Zhou, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **High-Frequency Trading on Decentralized On-Chain Exchanges** *IEEE S&P'21*

L Zhou, K Qin, C Torres, D Le, A Gervais.

Core A* Security **On the Just-In-Time Discovery of Profit-Generating Transactions in DeFi Protocols** *IEEE S&P'21*

L Zhou, K Qin, A Cully, B Livshits, A Gervais.

Teaching

INFO5995: Introduction to Cybersecurity @ The University of Sydney *2026 Semester 1*

INFO2222: Computing 2 Usability and Security @ The University of Sydney *2025 Semester 1*

Services

Program Chair / Program Committee Co-Chair

Web3 Scholars Conference 2026

ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security 2024, 2025

Program Committee

Core A* USENIX Security	2026
Core A* The ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS)	2025, 2026
Core A Financial Cryptography and Data Security (FC)	2024, 2025, 2026, 2027
The Science of Blockchain (Stanford)	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
The Latest in DeFi Research (TL;DR)	2024, 2025
CESC Crypto Economics Security Conference (UC Berkeley)	2022
ACM CCS Workshop on Decentralized Finance and Security	2021, 2022, 2023

Invited Reviewer

Transactions on Information Forensics & Security	2023
Financial Innovation	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing	2023

External Reviewer

Core A* IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy	2023

Awards and Grants

ARC DECRA Fellowship, 527,178 AUD, Advancing AI for Software Exploit Generation	*Ongoing, 2026*
Sui Academic Research Awards, 25k USD	*Awarded, 2025*
Innosuisse Start-Up Innovation, 703k CHF, AI-Enhanced Smart Contract Auditing	*Completed*, 2024
Ethereum Academic Grant 2024, 55k USD, Training an EVM-native GPT	*Completed, 2024*
Ethereum Academic Grant 2023, 72k USD, Blockchain Censorship DoS	*Completed*, 2023
Ethereum Academic Grant 2023, 25k USD, Blockchain Censorship Measurement	*Completed*, 2023

Education

PhD in Computer Science	Imperial College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2019 – Feb 2025*
MRes in Web Science and Big Data Analytics	University College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2017 – Sep 2018*
MSci & ARCS in Maths and Computer Science	Imperial College London, United Kingdom *Oct 2010 – Sep 2014*

Other Experiences

Co-founder, Decentralized Intelligence AG (D23E)